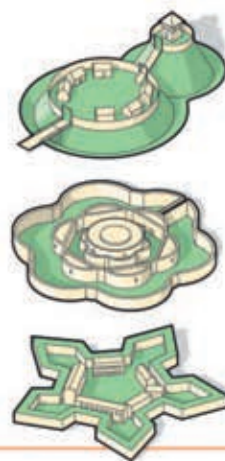


Castles

A castle was the imposing residence of a lord, built as a fortress, to withstand enemy attack. It was also a community where the lord and his family, his garrison of soldiers, and his many servants lived and worked.

TYPES OF CASTLE

The design of castles changed as weapons of attack developed. The earliest castles were built from earth and timber. Then, during the 12th century, lords began to build castles from stone. Although they took longer to build and more skill, they were much stronger and did not burn like wood.



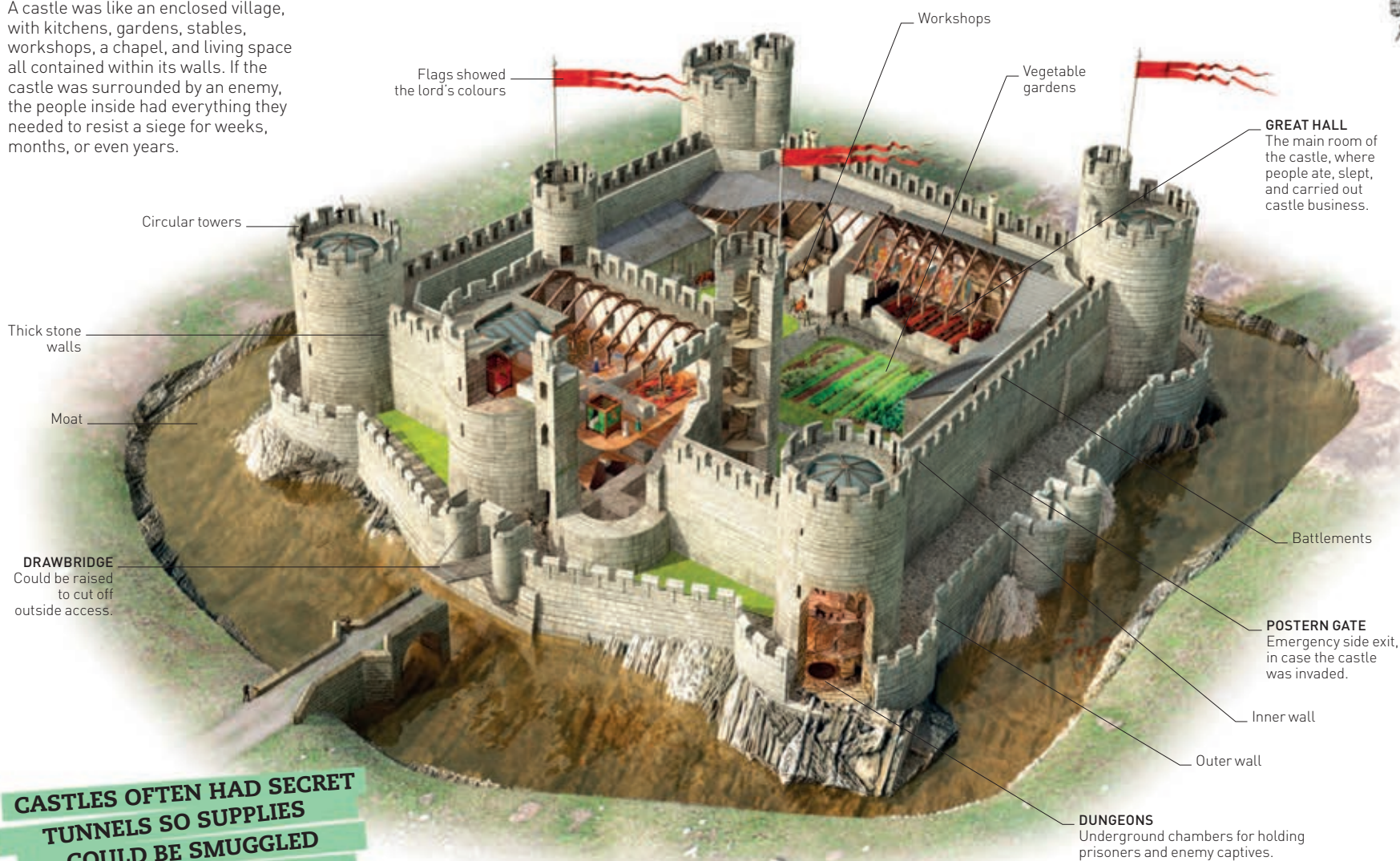
MOTTE AND BAILEY
11th and 12th centuries. A wooden castle is built on a motte (mound), surrounded by a fortified enclosure.

CONCENTRIC
12th–15th century. A central fortress is surrounded by layers of stone walls.

STAR FORT
15th–20th century. Shape deflects cannon fire and allows defenders to fire from several angles.

INSIDE A CASTLE

A castle was like an enclosed village, with kitchens, gardens, stables, workshops, a chapel, and living space all contained within its walls. If the castle was surrounded by an enemy, the people inside had everything they needed to resist a siege for weeks, months, or even years.



CASTLES OFTEN HAD SECRET TUNNELS SO SUPPLIES COULD BE SMUGGLED IN DURING A SIEGE

BUILT FOR DEFENCE

Many castles had features to make it as difficult as possible for attackers to get inside. Towers were built on either side of the vulnerable gatehouse, so that defenders could rain missiles or boiling water down on uninvited visitors. Often the lord chose to site his castle on a hillside or clifftop so that he and his men had a good view of anyone approaching.



MOAT

A wide, steep-walled ditch around the castle, usually filled with water.



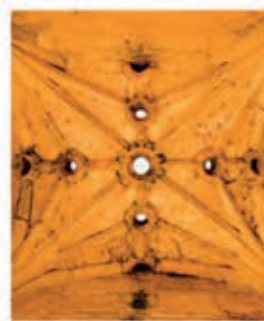
GATEHOUSE

The main entrance was often fortified by a movable iron grate called a portcullis.



ARROW AND GUN LOOPS

The thick walls had narrow slits through which a soldier could fire missiles at attackers.



GATEHOUSE CEILING HOLES

Boiling water or other harmful liquids could be dropped on to intruders.



SPIRAL STAIRCASE

Narrow, spiral staircases meant that invaders could not easily use swords while climbing.